

Tentative Rulings for June 25, 2026
Department 503

For any matter where an oral argument is requested and any party to the hearing desires a remote appearance, such request must be timely submitted to and approved by the hearing judge. In this department, the remote appearance will be conducted through Zoom. If approved, please provide the department's clerk a correct email address. (CRC 3.672, Fresno Sup.C. Local Rule 1.1.19)

There are no tentative rulings for the following cases. The hearing will go forward on these matters. If a person is under a court order to appear, he/she must do so. Otherwise, parties should appear unless they have notified the court that they will submit the matter without an appearance. (See California Rules of Court, rule 3.1304(c).) *The above rule also applies to cases listed in this "must appear" section.*

The court has continued the following cases. The deadlines for opposition and reply papers will remain the same as for the original hearing date.

(Tentative Rulings begin at the next page)

Tentative Rulings for Department 503

Begin at the next page

(03)

Tentative Ruling

Re: ***Aguilar v. Saint Agnes Medical Center***
Case No. 23CECG02274

Hearing Date: June 25, 2026 (Dept. 503)

Motion: Defendant Dr. Roshan's Motion for Summary Judgment, or in the Alternative Summary Adjudication

Tentative Ruling:

To deny Dr. Roshan's motion for summary judgment, and the alternative motion for summary adjudication.

Explanation:

“‘The standard of care against which the acts of a physician are to be measured is a matter peculiarly within the knowledge of experts; it presents the basic issue in a malpractice action and can only be proved by their testimony, unless the conduct required by the particular circumstances is within the common knowledge of the layman.’” (*Landeros v. Flood* (1976) 17 Cal.3d 399, 410, citations omitted.)

“ ‘California courts have incorporated the expert evidence requirement into their standard for summary judgment in medical malpractice cases. When a defendant moves for summary judgment and supports his motion with expert declarations that his conduct fell within the community standard of care, he is entitled to summary judgment unless the plaintiff comes forward with conflicting expert evidence.’” (*Munro v. Regents of University of California* (1989) 215 Cal.App.3d 977, 984–985, citations omitted.)

“[W]hen considering the declarations of the parties' experts, we liberally construe the declarations for the plaintiff's experts and resolve any doubts as to the propriety of granting the motion in favor of the plaintiff.” (*Powell v. Kleinman* (2007) 151 Cal.App.4th 112, 125–126, citation omitted.) Thus, a plaintiff's expert declaration in opposition to defendant's summary judgment motion “did not have to be detailed, was entitled to all favorable inferences and was deemed sufficient to defeat the summary judgment motion.” (*Id.* at p. 125, citing *Hanson v. Grode* (1999) 76 Cal.App.4th 601, 607–608.)

Furthermore, the plaintiff does not have to prove that the defendant's acts or omissions were the sole cause of the plaintiff's injuries. Plaintiff only has to present admissible expert testimony that the defendant was a substantial cause of the injuries. (CACI No. 430; *Mitchell v. Gonzales* (1991) 54 Cal.3d 1041, 1052.)

Here, defendant Dr. Roshan has met his burden of showing that he is entitled to summary judgment, as he has submitted the declaration of his expert, Dr. Posalski, who opines that nothing Dr. Roshan did or failed to do fell below the standard of care or caused decedent's death. (Posalski decl., ¶ 7.) Dr. Posalski also discusses his reasons for concluding that Dr. Roshan did not breach the standard of care or cause decedent's death. (*Ibid.*) Thus, the burden shifts to plaintiff to provide a declaration from a qualified

expert stating that Dr. Roshan's care and treatment of decedent fell below the standard of care and caused or substantially contributed to decedent's death.

In her opposition, plaintiff provides the declaration of Dr. Bailey, who is an expert in internal medicine and infectious diseases. Dr. Bailey opines that “[g]enuine and triable issues of material fact exist with regard to whether Dr. Roshan and his colleagues met the applicable standard of care for an infectious disease specialists [sic] from May 5, 2022 until decedent was transferred to UCLA on 5/21/22.” (Bailey decl., ¶ 14(a).) “Genuine and triable issues of material fact exist as to whether Dr. Roshan's and colleagues' acts and omissions, including the failure to recognize the risk of prolonged meropenem treatment and de-escalate to a narrower-spectrum effective agent once sensitivity of the 5/05/22 *Pseudomonas* isolate was reported, failure to obtain a sternal wound culture and recommend repeat chest CT scan when purulent drainage was observed on 5/17/2022 in conjunction with clinical deterioration (re-intubation and re-emergence of positive sepsis screen results on that date), and failure to consider more aggressive treatment beyond quinolone monotherapy (levofloxacin) for MDRO *Pseudomonas* once identified from the 5/15/22 respiratory culture on 5/19/22 in light of the recent 5/17 deterioration noted previously [such as addition of Zerbaxa (ceftolozane-tazobactam) as was done after transfer by the UCLA team] were substantial factors contributing to delay in placing Noe Aguilar on the transplant liver list following his transfer to UCLA for that purpose and his ultimate death on June 11, 2022.” (*Id.* at ¶ 14(b).)

Many of the actions or inactions that are mentioned in Dr. Bailey's declaration occurred after Dr. Roshan stopped treating decedent on May 8, 2022. For example, the alleged failure to obtain a sternal wound culture and recommend a repeat chest CT scan after purulent drainage was observed on May 17, 2022 were events that occurred after May 8, 2022, and thus are not evidence that Dr. Roshan's care and treatment of decedent fell below the standard of care. However, the alleged failure to switch to a narrow-spectrum antibiotic and keep administering a broad-spectrum antibiotic apparently occurred on May 5, 2022, when Dr. Roshan was treating decedent. The failure to switch to a narrow-spectrum antibiotic was also allegedly a substantial factor in causing the delay in putting decedent on the liver transplant list, which ultimately led to his death on June 11, 2022. (*Ibid.*)

Thus, plaintiff has met her burden of showing the existence of triable issues of material fact with regard to whether Dr. Roshan's care and treatment of decedent fell below the standard of care and caused or substantially contributed to his death. As a result, the court intends to deny Dr. Roshan's motion for summary judgment, and the alternative motion for summary adjudication.

Pursuant to California Rules of Court, rule 3.1312(a), and Code of Civil Procedure section 1019.5, subdivision (a), no further written order is necessary. The minute order adopting this tentative ruling will serve as the order of the court and service by the clerk will constitute notice of the order.

Tentative Ruling

Issued By: JS **on** 6/22/2025.
(Judge's initials) (Date)

(34)

Tentative Ruling

Re: ***Yous v. Stovall***
Superior Court Case No. 26CU00346

Hearing Date: June 25, 2026 (Dept. 503)

Motion: Expedited Petition to Approve Compromise of Minor's Claim

Tentative Ruling:

To grant the amended petition filed June 10, 2026. The court intends to sign the proposed orders. No appearances are necessary.

The court sets a status conference for Tuesday, September 29, 2026 at 3:30 p.m., in Department 503, for confirmation of deposit of the minor's funds into a blocked account. If Petitioner files the Acknowledgment of Receipt of Order and Funds for Deposit in Blocked Account (MC-356) at least five court days before the hearing, the status conference will come off calendar.

Pursuant to California Rules of Court, rule 3.1312(a), and Code of Civil Procedure section 1019.5, subdivision (a), no further written order is necessary. The minute order adopting this tentative ruling will serve as the order of the court and service by the clerk will constitute notice of the order.

Tentative Ruling

Issued By: JS on 6/23/2026.
(Judge's initials) (Date)

(34)

Tentative Ruling

Re: ***In re: Isaak Candelas***
Superior Court Case No. 26CU00384

Hearing Date: June 25, 2026 (Dept. 503)

Motion: Expedited Petition to Approve Compromise of Minor's Claim

Tentative Ruling:

To grant the amended petition filed June 12, 2026. The court intends to sign the proposed orders. No appearances are necessary.

The court sets a status conference for Tuesday, September 29, 2026 at 3:30 p.m., in Department 503, for confirmation of deposit of the minor's funds into a blocked account. If Petitioner files the Acknowledgment of Receipt of Order and Funds for Deposit in Blocked Account (MC-356) at least five court days before the hearing, the status conference will come off calendar.

Pursuant to California Rules of Court, rule 3.1312(a), and Code of Civil Procedure section 1019.5, subdivision (a), no further written order is necessary. The minute order adopting this tentative ruling will serve as the order of the court and service by the clerk will constitute notice of the order.

Tentative Ruling

Issued By: JS on 6/23/2026.
(Judge's initials) (Date)

(41)

Tentative Ruling

Re: ***Harout Torosian v. BMW of North America, LLC***
Superior Court Case No. 24CECG04794

Hearing Date: June 25, 2026 (Dept. 503)

Motion: By Defendant BMW of North America, LLC for Summary
Judgment or Summary Adjudication

Tentative Ruling:

To deny defendant's motion for summary judgment, and the alternative motion for summary adjudication.

Explanation:

On April 26, 2023, the plaintiff, Harout Torosian (Plaintiff), leased a new 2023 BMW 760i (Subject Vehicle) from BMW Fresno, an independent dealer. On November 4, 2024, Plaintiff filed a complaint (Complaint) against the manufacturer, BMW of North America, LLC (Defendant), seeking remedies under the Song-Beverly Consumer Warranty Act (the Act or Song-Beverly). Plaintiff alleges the following five causes of action against Defendant: (1) violation of Civil Code section 1793.2, subdivision (d); (2) violation of Civil Code section 1793.2, subdivision (b); (3) violation of Civil Code section 1793.2, subdivision (a)(3); (4) breach of express warranty (Civ. Code, § 1791.2, subd. (a)); and (5) breach of implied warranty of merchantability (Civ. Code, §§ 1791.1, 1794). Defendant now moves for summary judgment or summary adjudication

Legal Standard for Summary Judgment

Code of Civil Procedure section 437c, subdivision (c) provides that summary judgment "shall be granted if all the papers submitted show that there is no triable issue as to any material fact and that the moving party is entitled to a judgment as a matter of law." A defendant moving for summary judgment has the initial burden of presenting evidence that a cause of action lacks merit because the plaintiff cannot establish an element of the cause of action or there is a complete defense. (Code Civ. Proc., § 437c, subd. (p)(2); *Aguilar v. Atlantic Richfield Co.* (2001) 25 Cal.4th 826, 853 (*Aguilar*).) If the defendant satisfies this initial burden, the burden shifts to the plaintiff to present evidence demonstrating there is a triable issue of material fact. (Code Civ. Proc., § 437c, subd. (p)(2); *Aguilar*, at p. 850.)

The trial court must "carefully scrutinize the moving party's papers and resolve all doubts regarding the existence of material, triable issues of fact in favor of the party opposing the motion." (*Connelly v. County of Fresno* (2006) 146 Cal.App.4th 29, 36.) The court must strictly construe the moving party's declarations and liberally construe the opposing party's declarations. (*Villacres v. ABM Industries Inc.* (2010) 189 Cal.App.4th 562, 575 [affirming trial court's granting of employer's summary judgment motion]; *Binder v. Aetna Life Ins. Co.* (1999) 75 Cal.App.4th 832, 839 [reversing summary judgment where

evidence suggested strong possibility trier of fact would resolve issues in favor of moving defendant, but not necessarily so].) "A triable issue of fact is created when the evidence reasonably permits the trier of fact, under the applicable standard of proof, to find the purportedly contested fact in favor of the party opposing the motion." (*Loomis v. Amazon.com LLC* (2021) 63 Cal.App.5th 466, 475 [reversing summary judgment where genuine issues of material fact existed on consumer's strict products liability claim].)

When, as here, a defendant moves for summary judgment, the California Supreme Court has explained the defendant's initial burden as follows:

All that the defendant need do is to "show[] that one or more elements of the cause of action ... cannot be established" by the plaintiff. [Citation.] In other words, all that the defendant need do is to show that the plaintiff cannot establish at least one element of the cause of action—for example, that the plaintiff cannot prove element X. Although he remains free to do so, the defendant need not himself conclusively negate any such element—for example, himself prove *not* X.

(*Aguilar, supra*, 25 Cal.4th at pp. 853–854, original italics, footnotes omitted.)

Defendant Fails to Satisfy Its Initial Burden

The Act, popularly known as the "lemon law," provides various remedies to buyers of defective motor vehicles. The Act includes Civil Code section 1793.2, which governs a manufacturer's repair duties for an express warranty. Defendant moves for an order granting summary judgment, and alternatively, summary adjudication on the following grounds:

1. [Plaintiff's] First Cause of Action fails as a matter of law because all warranted defects were successfully repaired after a single repair attempt.
2. Plaintiff's Second Cause of Action for violation of § 1793.2(b)'s 30-day repair requirement fails as a matter of law because repairs were completed within 30 days and Plaintiff has offered no evidence of damages caused by any alleged violation.
3. Plaintiff's Third Cause of Action for violation of Civ. Code § 1793.2(a)(3), fails as a matter of law because BMW provided sufficient literature or replacement parts necessary to perform the two warranted repairs.
4. Plaintiff's Fourth Cause of Action fails as a matter of law because all warranted defects were successfully repaired after a single repair attempt.

(Ntc., p. 2:1-10.)

Summary Judgment

A motion for summary judgment is generally directed toward an entire action or pleading. (Code of Civ. Proc., § 437c, subd. (a).) By comparison "[a] party may move for summary adjudication as to one or more causes of action within an action" (Code Civ. Proc., § 437c, subd. (f)(1).) When a defendant moves for summary judgment, the defendant has the burden to show it is entitled to judgment on all theories of liability

alleged by the plaintiff. (*Lopez v. Superior Court* (1996) 45 Cal.App.4th 705, 717.) If a defendant fails to address all theories of liability alleged in the complaint, the trial court should stop its analysis and deny the motion for summary judgment:

If the defendant does not address an issue in a motion for summary judgment that has been raised in the plaintiff's complaint, it fails to meet its initial burden to show the plaintiff's action has no merit; the motion therefore fails to shift the burden to the plaintiff to oppose summary judgment. [Citation.]

(*Hedayati v. Interinsurance Exchange of the Automobile Club* (2021) 67 Cal.App.5th 833, 846.)

Here, the Complaint includes a fifth cause of action for breach of the implied warranty of merchantability. In its notice of motion, Defendant gives no notice to Plaintiff that Defendant seeks summary adjudication of the fifth cause of action. Nor does Defendant establish in its moving papers that the fifth cause of action has no merit. Therefore, Defendant fails to meet its initial burden to address all theories of liability alleged in the Complaint, and the court denies the motion for summary judgment.

Summary Adjudication of First and Fourth Causes of Action (Issues 1 and 4)

Although Defendant fails to address the fifth cause of action, the court must consider Defendant's alternate motion for summary adjudication of the first four causes of action. In its separate statement, Defendant designates each cause of action as issues one through four. Defendant relies on a total of fifteen different facts, or subsets of these fifteen facts, depending on the issue.¹ Defendant analyzes the merits of the first cause of action (Issue 1) and the fourth cause of action (Issue 4) together, based on the same (restated) fifteen facts. The parties agree on the elements Plaintiff must prove to recover under the Act:

A plaintiff pursuing an action under the Act has the burden to prove that (1) the vehicle had a nonconformity covered by the express warranty that substantially impaired the use, value or safety of the vehicle (the nonconformity element); (2) the vehicle was presented to an authorized representative of the manufacturer of the vehicle for repair (the presentation element); and (3) the manufacturer or his representative did not repair the nonconformity after a reasonable number of repair attempts (the failure to repair element).

¹ Defendant's separate statement is confusing because Defendant rennumbers the same facts, depending on the issue. Defendant relies on the same complete set of 15 facts for Issue 1 and Issue 4. For Issue 2, Defendant relies on a subset of the same facts, then rennumbers all of the facts except Fact Nos. 1 and 2, which remain the same as in Issue 1. Specifically, Defendant deletes Fact Nos. 3, 4, 8, and 9 (from Issue 1), then repeats and rennumbers the remaining facts. For Issue 3, Defendant relies on a subset of 4 facts, restating its original Issue 1, Fact Nos. 5, 6, and 7, as Issue 3, Fact Nos. 1, 2, and 3, and rennumbering Issue 1, Fact No. 15, as Issue 3, Fact No. 4.

(*Oregel v. American Isuzu Motors, Inc.* (2001) 90 Cal.App.4th 1094, 1101, citing Civ. Code, § 1793.2; *Ibrahim v. Ford Motor Co.* (1989) 214 Cal.App.3d 878, 886-887.)

Defendant relies on *Silvio v. Ford Motor Co.*, (2003) 109 Cal. App. 4th 1205, which holds that a manufacturer must be allowed more than one attempt to repair a vehicle before the remedies under the Act become effective. (*Id.* at pp. 1208-1209.) Defendant contends Plaintiff cannot prove "the failure to repair" element because Plaintiff presented the Subject Vehicle for only two warranted repairs, and both warranted defects were successfully repaired after a single repair attempt.

Defendant submits evidence that before the first presentation of the Subject Vehicle on March 14, 2024, Plaintiff was notified of a recall campaign for the integrated brake system. (Fact Nos. 7, 9, 10.) On March 14, 2024, Plaintiff asked BMW Fresno about the status of the integrated brake system recall because he "was experiencing lapse of braking a little bit[.]" (Fact Nos. 9, 10 [Wasson decl., ex. 7, Torosian depo., p. 39:7-8].) Defendant acknowledges its representative refused Plaintiff's request for a safety inspection concerning the "lapse in braking.":

On March 14, 2024, Plaintiff inquired regarding the status of the integrated brake system recall when presenting the Subject Vehicle to BMW Fresno for service. BMW Fresno informed Plaintiff that the remedy was not yet available for the Subject Vehicle and promised to schedule a service appointment once the recall was ready.

(Fact No. 10; [see supporting Wasson decl., ex. 7, Torosian depo., p. 38:21-22 (Plaintiff stated, "That was my first instance of kind of being turned away onsite about the safety issue")].)

In addition to notifying the service dealer that he was concerned about the safety of his vehicle and the lapse in braking, Plaintiff called Defendant (manufacturer) the next day to request written documentation to ensure his safety. (Fact No. 11.) Defendant was unable to provide the written documentation requested by Plaintiff. (*Ibid.*) Defendant "addressed the integrated brake system recall for the Subject Vehicle" 47 days later, on April 30, 2024. (Fact No. 13.) In October 2024 Defendant issued a new recall notice because further hardware updates were required under the integrated brake system recall. (Fact No. 14.) On October 29, 2024, the Subject Vehicle was declared a total loss following an accident not caused by Plaintiff. (Fact No. 15.)

Defendant presents undisputed evidence to show the repair for Plaintiff's first and second presentations of the Subject Vehicle each took two days. (Fact Nos. 5, 6.) In its moving papers, with no citation to authority, Defendant contends, "All other 'repairs' performed on the Subject Vehicle were for recalls and product improvements performed prophylactically." (Memo., p. 10:20-21.) With no analysis, Defendant appears to argue it had no obligation to "address" the integrated brake system recall because the Subject Vehicle had only two nonconformities—the recall was strictly prophylactic and all problems with the brakes did not fall within the nonconformity element.

The Act defines a "nonconformity" as "a nonconformity which substantially impairs the use, value, or safety of the new motor vehicle to the buyer or lessee." (Civ. Code, §

1793.22, subd. (e)(1).) In its reply, Defendant argues 'Plaintiff has identified no competent evidence that prior to the April 30, 2024, recall remedy, BMW Fresno ever verified any integrated brake system malfunction in the Subject Vehicle . . . [or] duplicated a braking event[.]' (Rpy., p. 3:18-20.)

But Defendant itself presents evidence that Plaintiff expressed concern about the safety of the brakes on the Subject Vehicle, which he described as a "lapse in braking." BMW Fresno refused Plaintiff's March 14, 2024, request to schedule a service appointment for the brakes (Fact Nos. 9, 10), and Defendant refused to provide documentation to ensure the safety of the Subject Vehicle (Fact No. 11). Based on this evidence, a trier of fact might find that Plaintiff had a problem with the brakes, which affected the safety, value, or use of the Subject Vehicle, but upon request, Defendant and its representative refused to inspect or repair the Subject Vehicle, nor did they provide safety assurances until a remedy for the recall was ready.

Carefully scrutinizing Defendant's papers and resolving all doubts regarding the existence of material, triable issues of fact in Plaintiff's favor, the court finds Defendant's own submitted evidence provides a reasonable basis for the trier of fact to conclude it is more likely than not that Plaintiff presented the Subject Vehicle to BMW Fresno for inspection of the brakes on at least two occasions (March 14, 2024 [Fact No. 5 (see also March 15, 2024 [Fact No. 11]); April 30, 2024 [Fact No.7]); and Defendant or its representative refused to inspect, repair, or rule out the nonconformity in the Subject Vehicle (which affected the safety, use, or value of the Subject Vehicle) after a reasonable number of repair attempts—although the trier of fact might also reach the opposite conclusion. Therefore, Defendant falls to meet its initial burden of persuasion and production on the first and fourth causes of action and the burden does not shift to Plaintiff to raise a triable issue of material fact.

Summary Adjudication of Second Cause of Action (Issue 2)

Defendant directs its motion for summary adjudication on Issue 2 to Plaintiff's second cause of action. Plaintiff alleges Defendant failed to commence the service or repairs within a reasonable time to conform to the applicable warranties within 30 days, in violation of Civil Code section 1793.2, subdivision (b), which provides:

Where those service and repair facilities are maintained in this state and service or repair of the goods is necessary because they do not conform with the applicable express warranties, service and repair shall be commenced within a reasonable time by the manufacturer or its representative in this state. Unless the buyer agrees in writing to the contrary, the goods shall be serviced or repaired so as to conform to the applicable warranties within 30 days. Delay caused by conditions beyond the control of the manufacturer or its representatives shall serve to extend this 30-day requirement. Where delay arises, conforming goods shall be tendered as soon as possible following termination of the condition giving rise to the delay.

For Issue 2, Defendant offers two reasons for summary adjudication. First, in its moving papers, rather than focusing on when repairs were commenced, Defendant

provides evidence that the Subject Vehicle spent a total of 13 days out of service, in an attempt to show the repairs were "completed" within 30 days.

Defendant also presents evidence that the repair for the integrated brake system commenced 47 days after Plaintiff presented the Subject Vehicle for the brake problem. (Fact Nos. 3, 9 [Issue 2].) In its reply, Defendant relies on the extension of the 30-day requirement for a delay caused by conditions beyond the manufacturer's control. (Civ. Code, § 1793.2, subd. (b).) But Defendant presents no facts in its moving papers to show why the delay to commence the brake service for more than 30 days was beyond its control. Therefore, Defendant fails to meet its burden to establish its first reason for summary adjudication on Issue 2.

For its second reason, Defendant argues that Plaintiff has suffered no damage. As the party moving for summary adjudication, Defendant must present evidence to show not only that Plaintiff has no evidence on an essential element, but Defendant "must also show that the plaintiff *cannot reasonably obtain* needed evidence[.]" (*Gaggero v. Yura* (2003) 108 Cal.App.4th 884, 889, italics original [trial court erred in granting summary judgment in defendant's favor where defendant failed to present evidence to show plaintiff could not reasonably obtain needed evidence].) Here, Defendant fails to establish that Plaintiff has no evidence to prove the alleged braking defects have substantially impaired the use, safety, or value of the Subject Vehicle.

The court finds Defendant fails to meet its initial burden to show the facts warrant a conclusion, as a matter of law, that the delay to commence the requested repair was due to circumstances outside of Defendant's control or that Plaintiff suffered no damage. Therefore, Defendant fails to meet its initial burden of persuasion and production on the second cause of action and the burden does not shift to Plaintiff to raise a triable issue of material fact.

Summary Adjudication of Third Cause of Action (Issue 3)

For his third cause of action, Plaintiff alleges a violation of Civil Code section 1793.2, subdivision (a)(3), which requires Plaintiff to show Defendant failed to "[m]ake available to authorized service and repair facilities sufficient service literature and replacement parts to effect repairs during the express warranty period." (*Ibid.*) Defendant presents four renumbered facts under Issue 3—the March 14, 2024, request to perform the brake recall (Fact No. 1); the March 28, 2024, presentation (Fact No. 2); Plaintiff's April 30, 2024, presentation of the Subject Vehicle to perform the brake recall (Fact No. 3); and the Subject Vehicle was declared a total loss after an accident caused by a third person before Defendant could "effectuate the hardware updates" (Fact No. 4).

Without citation to authority, Defendant disregards Plaintiff's requested repair of the integrated brake system on March 14, 2024, and the evidence Defendant itself submits of Plaintiff's deposition testimony that he continued to experience braking problems until the accident:

Q [By Mr. Wasson] Okay. I'm going to stop sharing my screen.
We just had two repair orders with non-recall-related
issues that we went over. To tie a bow on everything,

are there any other issues that you have experienced that we have not discussed today?

A [By Plaintiff] I did -- as stated previously, I did have issues with the braking. As I said, me feeling it as a driver and hence why it initiated me to make some phone calls to the dealership and to the manufacturer directly to ask for assistance on next steps. But that was the main subject of my issue and concerns. The limited amount of braking that was available on my vehicle.

(Wasson decl., ex. 7, Torosian depo., p. 52:13-25.)

Defendant's evidence fails to meet its initial burden of persuasion and production to show, as a matter of law, that Plaintiff cannot prove that Defendant failed to make sufficient service literature and replacement parts available to its authorized repair facility to effect repairs within the warranty period. Therefore, the burden does not shift to Plaintiff to raise a triable issue of material fact on Issue 3.

Conclusion

When the moving party fails to make the initial showing, it is unnecessary to review the opposing party's evidence and the court must deny the motion. (*Aguilar, supra*, 25 Cal.4th at p. 849-850; *Hawkins v. Wilton* (2006) 144 Cal.App.4th 936, 940 [defendant's motion for summary judgment should have been denied without looking at opposing evidence because defendant failed to refute tenable pleaded theories].) Here, the burden here does not shift to Plaintiff to raise a triable issue of fact and the court may stop its analysis here. Therefore, the court denies Defendant's motion for summary judgment and the alternative motion for summary adjudication on the first, second, third, and fourth causes of action of the Complaint.

Pursuant to California Rules of Court, rule 3.1312(a), and Code of Civil Procedure section 1019.5, subdivision (a), no further written order is necessary. The minute order adopting this tentative ruling will serve as the order of the court and service by the clerk will constitute notice of the order.

Tentative Ruling

Issued By: JS **on** 6/23/2026.
(Judge's initials)

(47)

Tentative Ruling

Re: ***Daniel Oliver vs. Nikolay N. Kotenoff***
Superior Court Case No. 25CECG04793

Hearing Date: June 25, 2026 (Dept. 503)

Motion: Plaintiff, Daniel Oliver's Motion to Compel Responses to Form Interrogatories, Special Interrogatories, Requests for Production of Documents, and to Deem Admitted the Admissions in Request for Admissions from each Defendant, and for costs.

Tentative Ruling:

To deny plaintiff Daniel Oliver's motion to compel responses to: Form Interrogatories; Special Interrogatories; Requests for Production of Documents; and to deem admitted the admissions in Request for Admissions, from each defendant.

To grant monetary sanctions in the amount of \$650, to be paid by plaintiff Daniel Oliver, to defendants counsel at the Harris Law Firm, PC. Sanctions shall be paid within 30 days of the notice of entry of this order.

Explanation:

Plaintiff, Daniel Oliver, ("plaintiff" or "Oliver") makes this motion to compel discovery from defendants Vera Oliver ("Vera") and Nikolay N. Kotenkoff ("Kotenkoff") (collectively "defendants") to: Form Interrogatories; Special Interrogatories; Requests for Production of Documents; and to deem admitted the admissions in Request for Admissions from each defendant.

A plaintiff may not serve interrogatories, requests for production, or requests for admission until ten days after service of the summons on, or appearance by, the responding party. (Code Civ. Proc., §§ 2030.020, subd. (b), 2031.020 subd. (b), 2033.020 subd. (b).)

Vera was personally served with the Complaint on November 10, 2025. Oliver's claimed service of discovery on November 16, 2025 therefore occurred before the statutory period permitting discovery had elapsed. (James R. Proctor III ("Proctor") Decl., ¶¶ 2-3.)

Plaintiff also propounded discovery directed on Kotenkoff on November 16, 2025. Based on the court's docket and filings, Oliver attempted service of the summons and complaint on Kotenkoff, but the proof of service was rejected as defective by the Court. No valid proof of service establishing proper service on Kotenkoff appears in the record. (Proctor Decl., ¶6.) Because the discovery was served before Kotenkoff was subject to discovery under the Civil Discovery Act, no obligation to respond ever arose, and Oliver

cannot establish waiver, compel responses, or obtain sanctions based upon that defective service. (*Ruttenberg v. Ruttenberg* (1997) 53 Cal.App.4th 801, 808-809.)

Because of these procedural defects, the Court denies Oliver's motion to compel responses to: Form Interrogatories; Special Interrogatories; Requests for Production of Documents; and to deem admitted the admissions in Request for Admissions, from each defendant.

Defendants, in turn, request monetary sanctions against Oliver for misuse of the discovery process pursuant to Code of Civil Procedure section 2023.030, subdivision (a). Code of Civil Procedure section 2023.030, subdivision (a) provides, in relevant part: "The court may impose a monetary sanction ordering that one engaging in the misuse of the discovery process, or any attorney advising that conduct, or both pay the reasonable expenses, including attorney's fees, incurred by anyone as a result of that conduct."

Under these circumstances, the court orders monetary sanctions against Oliver for reasonable attorney fees in the amount of \$650 for defending against this motion. Defendants' counsel explained to Oliver that discovery had been premature. (Proctor Decl., ¶18.) Furthermore, self-representation is not a ground for lenient treatment and, as is the case with attorneys, a person who represents himself "must follow correct rules of procedure." *Nwosu v. Uba* (2004) 122 Cal. App.4th 1229, 1247.

Pursuant to California Rules of Court, rule 3.1312(a), and Code of Civil Procedure section 1019.5, subdivision (a), no further written order is necessary. The minute order adopting this tentative ruling will serve as the order of the court and service by the clerk will constitute notice of the order.

Tentative Ruling

Issued By: JS on 6//23/2026.
(Judge's initials) (Date)